

Current Affairs Digest

Morning Session Notes — Compiled September 14, 2026

1. BRICS Summit 2026 — Hosted by India (New Delhi)

- The 18th BRICS Summit was held in New Delhi; India was the host nation.
- Total participating countries (member + observer/partner) at the summit: 11.
- Number of official BRICS Partner Countries: 10.
- Newest full BRICS country added: **Indonesia** (President Prabowo Subianto attended).
- Newest BRICS Partner Country: **Vietnam**.
- Russian President Vladimir Putin attended and held a separate India–Russia Bilateral Summit — the **24th edition** of the India–Russia Annual Summit.
- Key bilateral discussion topics: the West Asia (Iran) conflict and the Russia–Ukraine conflict, and how to de-escalate both.
- Also present: Iran's President **Masoud Pezeshkian**, and UN Secretary-General **António Guterres** (belongs to Portugal).
- Discussion themes at the summit: education, trade, science, information technology and Artificial Intelligence, with focus on the two conflicts above.

BRICS — Key Statistics & Facts

- BRICS nations together hold ~49% of world population, ~26% of world trade, and ~40% of world GDP.
- Countries added to BRICS over time (after the original five): Egypt, Ethiopia, UAE, Iran, Saudi Arabia, and (most recently) Indonesia.
- BRICS logo: features a 'Namaste' symbol at the centre; the surrounding leaves represent the member countries.
- BRICS founded in **2001**; first summit held in **2006**; South Africa's addition was announced in 2009 and formalised in **2010**.
- 2025 Summit: Brazil. 2026 Summit: India (New Delhi). 2027 Summit: China (host announced by President Xi Jinping).
- China will focus its 2027 presidency on the 'Global South' — defined here as Asia, Africa and Latin America.
- China has hosted BRICS before: 2011, 2017, and virtually in 2022 — 2027 will be China's 4th hosting; counting the very first 2006 meeting (held in China), 2027 will be the 5th BRICS gathering held on Chinese soil overall.
- Theme of the 2026 New Delhi Summit: **Resilience, Cooperation, Innovation and Sustainability**.
- Declaration signed at the summit: the **Delhi Declaration** — a 45-page document, also addressing ongoing global conflicts.

Summit Backdrop — Rameshwaram (Ramanathaswamy) Temple

- The official photo backdrop at the BRICS venue was the **Rameshwaram Temple** (Tamil Nadu), also known as the Ramanathaswamy Temple.
- Located on Pabban (Pamban) Island, Tamil Nadu; part of the Char Dham Yatra (along with Puri, Dwarka, Badrinath).
- One of the 12 Jyotirlingas — the only Jyotirlinga located in Tamil Nadu.
- Built in Dravidian architectural style; features a Gopuram and walls built of granite.
- Believed to have been built/consecrated by Lord Rama while constructing the Ram Setu en route to Sri Lanka.
- Developed further by the Chola, Pallava and Pandya dynasties, largely in the 12th century.

2. Indian Railways — South Zone 100% Electrified

- Southern Railway zone has become **100% electrified**, completing the last **5,068 km** stretch.
- The final two sections electrified: **Puthukkottai** and **Karaikudi**, both in Tamil Nadu.
- Completion date: **9 September 2026**.
- Historical note: India's very first railway electrification took place on the **Bombay–Madras** route (Bombay first, then Madras).

3. Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF) — Akasa Air

- **Bharat Petroleum Corporation Ltd (BPCL)** (brand ambassador: Rahul Dravid) produced a Sustainable Aviation Fuel (SAF) that lowers carbon emissions/pollution.
- **Akasa Air** operated India's first commercial flight using a 1% SAF blend.
- Route: Mumbai (Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj International Airport) to Goa (Manohar International Airport, named after Manohar Parrikar).

4. Geography — 'Rice Bowl' Note & Monsoon

- The **Chota Nagpur Plateau** is referred to as the '**Ruhr of India**' — its largest share lies in Jharkhand and Chhattisgarh, with smaller parts in Bihar and Odisha.
- As taught in this session: the **retreating monsoon** phase is associated with the effect of **Western Disturbances** (per the instructor's classroom note).

5. WHO South-East Asia Regional Committee — 79th Session

- The **79th Session of the WHO Regional Committee for South-East Asia** was held from **7–10 September 2026** in **Dili, Timor-Leste** (Dili is the capital of Timor-Leste).
- Timor-Leste is located in the Pacific Ocean region and became a **new ASEAN member in 2025**.
- WHO Director-General: **Dr. Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus**.
- India's delegation was led by Union Health Minister **Shri J.P. Nadda**, who participated in the session.
- A **Delhi Declaration** (health-focused — distinct from the BRICS Delhi Declaration) was signed at this session.
- Key health data highlighted: around **75 million people** in the region suffer from hypertension; the region also set targets for eliminating TB, Malaria and HIV.
- ASEAN facts: last (2025) ASEAN meeting was held in **Malaysia** (theme: 'Truly Asia'); 2026 meeting will be hosted by the **Philippines**.
- ASEAN currently has **11 members** (India is not a member); ASEAN HQ is in **Jakarta**; ASEAN was formed in **1967**.
- India is not a member of WHO's not-applicable here — but is naturally part of WHO South-East Asia Region and participated.

6. Static/History GK Covered from MTS & NDA-CDS Papers

- Grounds for removal of a Supreme Court/High Court judge: **misbehaviour and incapacity**.
- Article 75 of the Constitution: the **Council of Ministers** is collectively responsible to the House of the People (Lok Sabha).
- Viceroy of India when the INC session was held in Bombay in 1904: Lord **Curzon**.
- Gandhi's Individual Satyagraha (1940) — main objective: to keep India from being dragged into World War II.
- Young revolutionary (age 14) who assassinated a British magistrate during the freedom movement: **Suniti Chowdhury**.
- CHSL exam update: admit cards are released close to the exam date; the next CHSL notification is expected around **25 September to 5 October 2026**.

7. India–China Relations — Flights Resume

- **China Southern Airlines** has resumed direct flights between **Guangzhou and Delhi** (from Indira Gandhi International Airport), using Boeing aircraft.
- Flights on this route had been suspended since **2019** (COVID-19 plus the Galwan Valley standoff).
- Three key border passes with China that have also been reopened recently: **Lipulekh, Nathu La and Shipki La**.

Quick China Facts

- Capital: Beijing. Currency: Yuan / Renminbi (RMB).
- Three Gorges Dam — the world's largest dam, built on the Yangtze River.
- Yangtze River is the largest river in Asia.
- Cyclones in this region are called **Typhoons**.
- Taklamakan Desert is located in China.

8. Yemen — Houthis Capture Port City of Mokha

- The Houthi rebel group has captured the Red Sea port city of **Mokha (also spelled Mocha)** in Yemen.
- The Houthis are backed by **Iran** and primarily target areas linked to Israel/the Gaza Strip (Hamas); a related group, **Hezbollah**, operates from Lebanon.
- Mokha is located on the **Red Sea**; Yemen sits on the Arabian Peninsula, with its capital at **Sana'a**.
- Nearby key locations: the **Gulf of Aden**, the **Strait of Bab-el-Mandeb**, and **Perim Island**.
- Mokha was a 14th-century port under Ottoman rule (used by Egyptian and Mesopotamian traders); it was redeveloped into a modern port in **1955**.

9. Rare Freshwater Fish Discovered — Arunachal Pradesh

- A rare species of fish not previously recorded in India has been found in **Bangong Lake, Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh** — the first record of this species in India.
- The species is normally found in Tibet and China; it lives only in freshwater/natural lakes.

- Bangong Lake is a freshwater lake located at an altitude of about **12,800 feet**.
- IUCN Red List status of the species: **Least Concern**.
- Arunachal Pradesh's border with China is demarcated by the **McMahon Line**, drawn in **1914**.

10. Other International Notes

- AI Summit: the 2025 edition was held in **Paris**; the 2026 edition was hosted in **India**.
- **Hirakud Dam** — used for flood control, irrigation and power generation; built on the **Mahanadi River** in **Odisha**.

11. Sports Current Affairs

US Open Tennis 2026 (Arthur Ashe Stadium, USA)

- Women's Final: **Elena Rybakina** (Kazakhstan) defeated **Aryna Sabalenka** (Belarus) 6-4, 5-7, 6-2.
- Rybakina has now won 3 Grand Slam titles and held the World No.1 ranking: Wimbledon (2022), Australian Open (2026), US Open (2026).
- Men's Final: **Alexander** (Zverev, Germany) defeated **Ben Shelton** (USA) 6-3, 7-6, 6-2 — this was Alexander's 2nd Grand Slam title of 2026.
- 2026 Grand Slam winners — Women: Australian Open: Elena; French Open: Myra (Russia); Wimbledon: Linda; US Open: Elena.
- 2026 Grand Slam winners — Men: Australian Open: Carlos; French Open: Alexander; Wimbledon: Jannik; US Open: Alexander.
- Grand Slam surfaces: Australian Open & US Open — hard court; French Open — clay court; Wimbledon — grass court (oldest Grand Slam).
- Legend **Roger Federer** was inducted into the Tennis Hall of Fame.

Asian Junior Hockey Championship (hosted in China)

- Men's Final: India defeated South Korea 4-1 to win the title for the **6th time** (11th edition of the tournament).
- Women's Final: India defeated hosts China to win the title for the **3rd time**; South Korea holds the most women's titles (4).

Athletics — Hammer Throw (Indian Athletics Series, Delhi)

- **Tania** (Uttar Pradesh) threw 68.35 m — a national record in her category.
- **Nirbhay** (Delhi) threw 71.02 m — a national record in his category.
- World record (Men): **Yuri Sedykh** (Russia/USSR) — 86.74 m. World record (Women): **Anita** (Poland) — 82.98 m.

Other Sports Notes

- 'Gentleman's Game' is the popular nickname for **Cricket**.
- Asia Cup Cricket: India defeated Sri Lanka to win the title (covered in detail in the next session).
- UN Sasakawa Award 2025 (for disaster management) was given to **Mohapatra**.

MCQ Compilation — All Quiz Questions from Today's Session

Q1. Who is the current President of Russia, with whom PM Modi held the India–Russia Annual Summit?

Ans: **Vladimir Putin**

Q2. Which country will organise/host the BRICS Summit in 2027?

Ans: **China (announced by President Xi Jinping)**

Q3. On what basis can a Supreme Court judge be removed from office?

Ans: **Misbehaviour and incapacity**

Q4. Under Article 75, the Council of Ministers is collectively responsible to which body?

Ans: **The House of the People (Lok Sabha)**

Q5. Who was the Viceroy of India when the INC session was held in Bombay in 1904?

Ans: **Lord Curzon**

Q6. What was the main objective of Gandhi's Individual Satyagraha (1940)?

Ans: **To prevent India from being drawn into World War II**

Q7. Which young revolutionary (age 14) assassinated a British magistrate during the freedom movement?

Ans: **Suniti Chowdhury**

Q8. Which railway network recently achieved 100% electrification (5,068 km)?

Ans: **Southern Railway zone**

Q9. Which plateau is known as the 'Ruhr of India'?

Ans: Chota Nagpur Plateau (mainly Jharkhand & Chhattisgarh)

Q10. Which monsoon system is also known as the retreating monsoon (per session)?

Ans: Western Disturbances

Q11. Where was the 79th session of the WHO Regional Committee for South-East Asia held (7–10 Sept 2026)?

Ans: Dili, Timor-Leste

Q12. Which country recently became a new member of ASEAN (2025)?

Ans: Timor-Leste

Q13. Who received the UN Sasakawa Award 2025 for disaster management?

Ans: Mohapatra

Q14. In which lake (Arunachal Pradesh) was a rare freshwater fish species recorded for the first time in India?

Ans: Bangong Lake, Tawang

Q15. Which port city in Yemen was recently captured by the Houthi rebel group?

Ans: Mokha (Mocha)

Q16. Which sport is popularly known as the 'Gentleman's Game'?

Ans: Cricket

Q17. Who won the US Open 2026 Women's Singles title, and whom did she defeat?

Ans: Elena Rybakina defeated Aryna Sabalenka

Q18. Who won the US Open 2026 Men's Singles title, and whom did he defeat?

Ans: Alexander (Zverev) defeated Ben Shelton

Q19. India's Men's Hockey team defeated which team to win the Asian Junior Hockey title (6th time)?

Ans: South Korea (4-1)

Q20. Which country hosted the Asian Junior Hockey Championship this year?

Ans: China